

TEMPO VERSUS VOLUME: INDIA'S WORLD CUP BATTING DILEMMA

A closer look at India's batting-order dilemma and why **flexibility** could be the key to a successful Women's T20 World Cup campaign.

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India has begun its pursuit of an elusive Women's T20 World Cup trophy in the tournament's 10th edition, being held in England and Wales.

Coming into the competition, batting appears to be Harmanpreet Kaur and Co.'s stronger suit. In Smriti Mandhana, Shafali Verma, Jemimah Rodrigues and the skipper herself, India boasts

four batters ranked among the top 12 in the ICC Women's T20I batting rankings.

However, with an embarrassment of riches at its disposal, India must still determine the optimal batting order.

Accelerators and fast starters

Contained within its top six, India has two distinct batting profiles.

In Smriti, Jemimah and Harmanpreet, it has three batters who are among the finest exponents

of a classical batting method. All three tend to start slowly before accelerating to match-defining effect once set.

On the other hand, it has three batters who have shown the ability to begin their innings at a quicker tempo by taking on risk earlier: Shafali, Richa Ghosh and Yastika Bhatia.

Shafali and Yastika have performed this role at the top of the order, while Richa has carved out a niche at the death.

